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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 19

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Inscripción en un intercambio de idiomas

Coordinator: Good afternoon, City Language Exchange. How can I help you?

Caller: Hello. I saw your advert online and I'd like to register for a conversation partner.

Coordinator: Wonderful, I can set that up for you. First, could I take your name?

Caller: Yes, it's Helena Fisher.

Coordinator: Before we start entering details, I should explain how I handle a language-exchange booking. I will establish the essential details first, then compare the practical options, and finally read the record back. That gives us a chance to correct a misunderstanding before anything is confirmed.

Caller: That approach works well for me for the language-exchange booking. I made some notes beforehand, although I was not sure whether every detail I found still applied, so I would rather verify it during this conversation.

Coordinator: And how do you spell your surname?

Caller: It's F-I-S-H-E-R.

Coordinator: Thank you, Helena. And could I have a phone number for you?

Caller: My mobile is 07944 218 305.

Caller: For this language-exchange booking, I am trying to balance cost with convenience. I need to understand what the standard arrangement includes and what would count as an optional extra, because changing plans later could be inconvenient.

Coordinator: Of course. In this language-exchange booking, I will separate firm conditions from optional features, and you can stop me whenever two alternatives sound too similar.

Coordinator: Got it. Now, can I ask what you do for a living? Are you a student?

Caller: No, I'm a nurse, actually. I work at the city hospital.

Coordinator: Lovely. And which language would you like to practise with us?

Caller: Spanish, please. In return I can help someone with English, which is my first language.

Coordinator: A language-exchange booking can involve names, dates and choices that need to be compared rather than heard in isolation. I will therefore use the full wording and repeat any number in a separate group. Please ask immediately if something conflicts with your notes.

Caller: I will. For the language-exchange booking, that will help me make a considered decision, especially because I may need to coordinate this with another commitment.

Coordinator: Perfect. And how would you describe your current level of Spanish?

Caller: I'd say intermediate. I studied it at school, but I've forgotten quite a lot.

Coordinator: That's no problem at all. Where would you prefer to meet your partner?

Caller: I was thinking a café would be nice and relaxed. Actually, no - a café gets too noisy. The library would be far better, because it's quiet.

Coordinator: Let me finish the language-exchange booking by summarising what I have recorded. For this language-exchange booking, I will review the choices in their final form, spell any unusual word, and explain what happens next. The summary closes the language-exchange booking, so even a minor correction is worth making now.

Caller: Good. During the language-exchange booking, I will listen carefully and interrupt if anything sounds different.

Coordinator: The library is a very popular choice. And which day of the week suits you best?

Caller: Could we make it Thursday? That's my day off.

Coordinator: Thursday works well. And is there any particular skill you'd like to concentrate on?

Caller: Mostly conversation, but I'd really like to improve my pronunciation - that's my weakest area.

Caller: Before we close the language-exchange booking, could you tell me how I should raise a question after today? I would prefer not to repeat the whole enquiry if one detail changes.

Coordinator: Certainly. Keep the reference on the confirmation and quote it when you contact us. A colleague can then see the agreed record, identify the single point that needs attention and explain whether the change affects anything else.

Coordinator: Noted. Now, let me explain our three membership levels before you decide. The Basic level is completely free, and you simply receive a welcome handbook full of tips. The Standard level costs fifteen pounds a year, and it adds a group meet-up once a month. And our Premium level, at forty pounds a year, gives you a weekly meeting instead, plus access to our online lessons.

Caller: That's really helpful. I think I'll start with the Standard level.

Coordinator: An excellent choice. I'll email you the details today.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Recorrido por un museo de ciencias

Good morning everyone, and welcome to the Riverside Science Museum. My name's Oliver, and I'll be giving you a quick introduction before you explore on your own. Before describing the individual features of this science-museum tour, it is useful to understand the overall sequence. The information for the science-museum tour follows the order in which most people encounter the site or activity, following the main route before considering possible variations. Knowing that sequence will make the later directions and choices in the science-museum tour easier to follow. Let me start with what's changed since your last visit. This year we've opened two brand-new attractions that I'd encourage you all to see. The first is a planetarium on the top floor, where you can lie back and watch the night sky.

The second is our outdoor energy garden, where science comes to life in the open air. We've also refurbished the café and updated the gift shop, and of course the ever-popular flight gallery is still here, exactly where it always was. Some arrangements connected with the science-museum tour may depend on the time of day or the number of visitors. During the science-museum tour, listen for the difference between a permanent feature and something available only at a stated time. Where a condition in the science-museum tour is fixed, it will be presented as a rule; where there is flexibility, it will be described as a recommendation. Now for some practical information. Guided tours of the main galleries leave every forty minutes from the information desk in the entrance hall.

Each guided tour lasts about an hour, so do allow enough time. If you're carrying bags, please leave them in the cloakroom on the ground floor, as large rucksacks aren't permitted in the galleries. Lockers are also available, and they cost two pounds. As the science-museum tour continues, staff may direct different groups along slightly different routes. Within the science-museum tour, a change to a minor detail does not necessarily alter the main programme. If an alternative becomes necessary during the science-museum tour, wait for the full announcement before moving, because the first place mentioned may be the one that is no longer available. Photography is welcome throughout the building, but we do ask you to switch off your flash, because it can damage some of the more delicate exhibits.

Do not try to memorise every detail of the science-museum tour at once. The key locations and decisions will be repeated in context. For now, concentrate on where the activity begins, which direction or sequence applies, and the point at which you may need to make a choice or ask a member of staff. A final way to follow the science-museum tour is to separate descriptive information from an instruction that requires action. General advice supports the visit, while a firm instruction must be followed. Keeping those functions separate will prevent an interesting detail from being mistaken for a change to the programme. Let me point out a few highlights. On the ground floor, our star attraction is a giant model heart, which is so big that you can actually walk right through it.

Upstairs, in the space gallery, you'll be able to see a genuine piece of moon rock, brought back by astronauts. And outside in the energy garden, you can try generating electricity yourself by pedalling a bicycle. If you become uncertain during the science-museum tour, pause at the next staffed point rather than following another group without checking. Explain the last location or instruction you

clearly remember, and staff can reconnect you with the correct sequence. This is especially important when two activities begin near one another or when a temporary diversion changes only one section of the route. The programme is designed to allow questions, so asking for clarification will not make you miss the main activity.

Finally, don't leave without visiting our temporary exhibition, which this season is all about robots. It runs until the end of August. Members receive a twenty per cent discount in the shop, and children under five come in free. Enjoy your visit, and please ask any of our staff if you need help. Before the science-museum tour moves to its final practical details, remember that similar locations or services may have different conditions. Listen for the full name, the direction attached to it and any time restriction. A descriptive example may help you recognise a place, but only a direct instruction tells you to change route or take action. If a temporary arrangement replaces the normal one, the replacement will be stated after the original is identified.

This final distinction connects the earlier overview with the choices that follow and helps prevent a familiar name from being confused with the service currently available.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Proyecto de estudios cinematográficos

Tutor: Come in, Maya and Tom. I've watched the first cut of your film-studies documentary, so let's talk it through.

Maya: Thanks. As you know, we chose to film the street musicians who perform around the old town.

Tutor: Yes - remind me why you settled on that particular subject?

Tutor: Before we settle on an interpretation for the film-studies project, we should separate what the evidence actually shows from what we expected to find. Our first idea may still help organise the work, but it should not decide how we describe the result.

Maya: Agreed. For the film-studies project, we can distinguish the central finding from our early assumptions. That will make the argument more credible.

Maya: Well, at first we wanted to interview professional film directors, but we soon realised that would be almost impossible to arrange. Street musicians were far easier to approach, and honestly the topic felt much fresher.

Tutor: A sensible decision. Now, what was the biggest challenge you faced during filming?

Maya: We also need to be careful about cause and association in the film-studies project. Two patterns can occur together without one necessarily producing the other, particularly when the sample is small, participants select themselves, or an uncontrolled factor affects both.

Tutor: Yes. A cautious conclusion is better than an unsupported causal claim.

Tom: The lighting actually turned out fine, and the performers were very happy to take part. The real headache was the sound - traffic noise in the background spoiled several of our best takes.

Tutor: Sound is always difficult outdoors. And what do you feel worked especially well?

Tutor: Another question is whether our categories for the film-studies project are precise enough for somebody else to repeat the procedure. We know what we intended because we designed it, but a reader only has the written definition.

Maya: For the film-studies project, let us test the instructions on somebody outside the group. That should reveal any ambiguity before the final version.

Maya: I'm proudest of the interviews. We let each musician tell their own story, and those personal moments give the film its emotional heart. The camerawork is a little shaky in places, but the interviews really carry it.

Tutor: I agree - the interviews are your strongest element. Now, my main criticism concerns the length. At twenty-five minutes, it's simply too long for this assignment; you need to bring it down to about fifteen.

Maya: The order of the film-studies project presentation matters as much as the individual sections. If we give every technical detail before explaining the central question, the audience may lose the thread.

Tutor: For the film-studies project, we can introduce the question, present only the method needed for the finding, and move secondary detail to an appendix.

Tom: We were worried you'd say that. We'll cut the opening section, which does drag a little.

Tutor: Good plan. And when you hand it in, remember the film must be uploaded to the department server, not brought in on a memory stick - the files are far too large for that.

Tutor: Our final review of the film-studies project should use the agreed criteria rather than simply whether we like the finished version. We need consistent terminology, evidence for each claim and a conclusion that answers the question without exaggeration.

Maya: I will turn those points into a checklist. Then we can compare our independent checks and revise only where they reveal a problem.

Maya: Understood. What else should we do before we submit?

Tutor: Let's agree the next steps. First, re-edit the film to reduce its length. Then add subtitles, because a few of the musicians are quite hard to follow. After that, record a short narration to introduce each performer. You'll also need to obtain written permission from every musician, or we can't screen the film in public. Finally, send me a rough version by next Friday, and I'll give you detailed feedback before the final deadline.

Maya: We should keep a note of any decision we change during the final review of the film-studies project, including the reason for it.

Tutor: Agreed. That record will stop us from reopening settled points without new evidence, and it will show which revision corrected a real weakness rather than merely changing the wording.

Tom: Great. Thank you so much.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: Almacenamiento de energía renovable

Good morning. In today's lecture I want to look at one of the greatest challenges in the shift to clean power: how we store energy from renewable sources. To place the energy-storage lecture in perspective, we need to distinguish the familiar modern description from the longer process that produced it. Within the energy-storage lecture, what now appears stable often emerged through several pathways rather than one smooth sequence. A simple list of events in the energy-storage lecture can hide those alternatives, so the discussion will emphasise why particular changes mattered. The problem starts with the nature of renewables themselves.

Sources such as solar panels and wind farms are intermittent, which means they only generate electricity when the sun is shining or the wind is blowing, and not at other times. Because supply and use rarely match, we need to capture surplus power and release it later, during periods of high demand - for instance, on a cold winter evening when everyone switches on the heating. Evidence for the energy-storage lecture does not come from a single source. Researchers may compare historical material with evidence gathered using modern instruments. Each source answers a different question and carries its own uncertainty. Agreement can increase confidence, while disagreement often reveals an assumption or a measurement problem that deserves closer examination. So what are the options?

The most widespread storage technology today relies on lithium-ion batteries, like those found in phones and electric cars, only on a much larger scale. A much older method is pumped hydro. When there is spare electricity, it is used to pump water uphill into a reservoir. Later, when power is needed, that water is released and flows back down through a turbine, which spins to generate electricity all over again. Scale is especially important when evaluating the energy-storage lecture. A process observed in one case, one community or one short trial may behave differently across a region or over several generations. In this energy-storage lecture, the lecture will return to this distinction in each case study. This comparison helps identify which conditions are essential and which are merely helpful.

There are other clever approaches too. In compressed-air storage, surplus electricity squeezes air into sealed underground caves; when demand rises, the air is let out to drive a generator. And in some solar power plants, mirrors focus the sun's heat to melt salt. The molten salt stays hot for many hours and can later boil water into steam. It is also worth noticing the language of certainty used in the energy-storage lecture. Some mechanisms are supported by direct observation, while others remain the best explanation available from indirect evidence. Scientific caution does not mean that every account is equally likely. Keep that distinction in mind as the examples are brought together.

The separate examples in the energy-storage lecture can finally be organised around three questions: what conditions begin a change, which mechanisms sustain it, and what consequences appear later. For the energy-storage lecture, it also makes similarities visible without pretending that every case is identical. The conclusion to the energy-storage lecture will use that framework to connect the details without extending them beyond the available evidence. Of course, every method

has its drawbacks. Batteries, although efficient, remain expensive, and their lifespan is limited, because after a certain number of charges they must be replaced. Worse still, the metals inside them, such as lithium and cobalt, are difficult and sometimes environmentally damaging to mine.

A useful final check is to ask what observation would make the present account of the energy-storage lecture less convincing. Identifying such evidence keeps the explanation testable and reveals where future research would be most informative. It also prevents a plausible narrative from being treated as complete merely because its separate examples fit together. Looking to the future, researchers are pursuing fresh ideas. One is to store spare renewable electricity in the form of hydrogen gas, which can be burned or fed into fuel cells whenever it is needed. Others are designing cheaper batteries that avoid rare metals altogether. With better storage, renewable energy could one day power our homes and cities around the clock.

One final point about the energy-storage lecture concerns the difference between a useful model and a complete explanation. A model selects the relationships that matter most for a particular question, so it can be informative even when it leaves out local variation. Problems arise when that simplification is forgotten and a result from one scale is treated as a rule for every case. The evidence discussed here should therefore be read with its conditions attached: the period observed, the population or material studied, the method used and the uncertainty that remains. Those conditions do not weaken the account; they show exactly where the conclusion is supported and where further observation would be needed.